

- ↔ 20–39 in (50–100 cm)
- ⚖ 25–35 lb (11.5–16 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐾 Mammals



Resplendent quetzal

Pharomachrus mocinno

Quetzals are a group of glossy birds found in tropical forests. The resplendent quetzal is the most extravagantly plumed, but when perched, upright, still, and silent, its long, green back makes it inconspicuous in the forest. It mostly eats fruit, especially wild avocados, but will occasionally feed on insects, small frogs, lizards, and snails.

Pairs are territorial, and they carve out a nest hole in a rotting tree. The female lays one or two eggs, which are incubated by both parents for 18 days. The male and female also take turns feeding the chicks; however, often only the male continues to do so for the last few days before the chicks can fly.

- ↔ 14–26 in (35–65½ cm)
- ⚖ 7–8 oz (200–225 g)
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🐾 Fruit, insects



▷ SPLENDID PLUMES

Resplendent quetzals are aptly named after the vibrant tail feathers of breeding males.



Common morpho

Morpho peleides

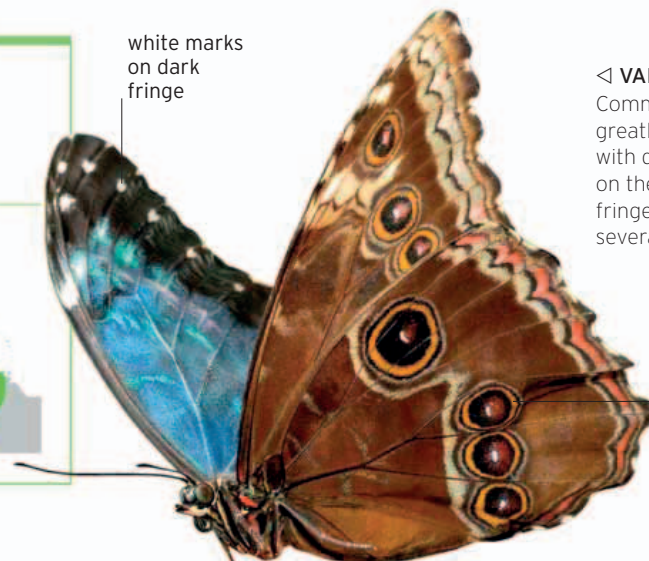
When viewed at rest with its wings folded up, the common morpho's wings are brown with several large eyespots. However, in flight, the upper wings produce a startling display of iridescent

blues and turquoises. Visible even in the thick foliage, the shimmering wings allow the butterflies to spot one another—males keep their distance, while females seek out mates.

- ↔ 4–5 in (9.5–12 cm)
- ⊗ Not known
- 🐾 Juices of ripe fruits



white marks on dark fringe



black-and-yellow-ringed eyespots

< VARIOUS FORMS

Common morphos vary greatly in color and form, with different markings on the wing margins and fringes, and there are several subspecies.